

Unnatural Products

A Santa Cruz biotech company creating synthetic macrocyclic peptides





Today's agenda

Things to go over today



1.
Origins



2.
What they do



3.
**Investors &
partners**



Leadership



Cameron Pye
Co-founder & CEO



Joshua Schwochert
Co-founder & CEO



Simon Bailey
COO & President of R&D



Henry Johnson
VP Medicinal Chemistry &
CMC



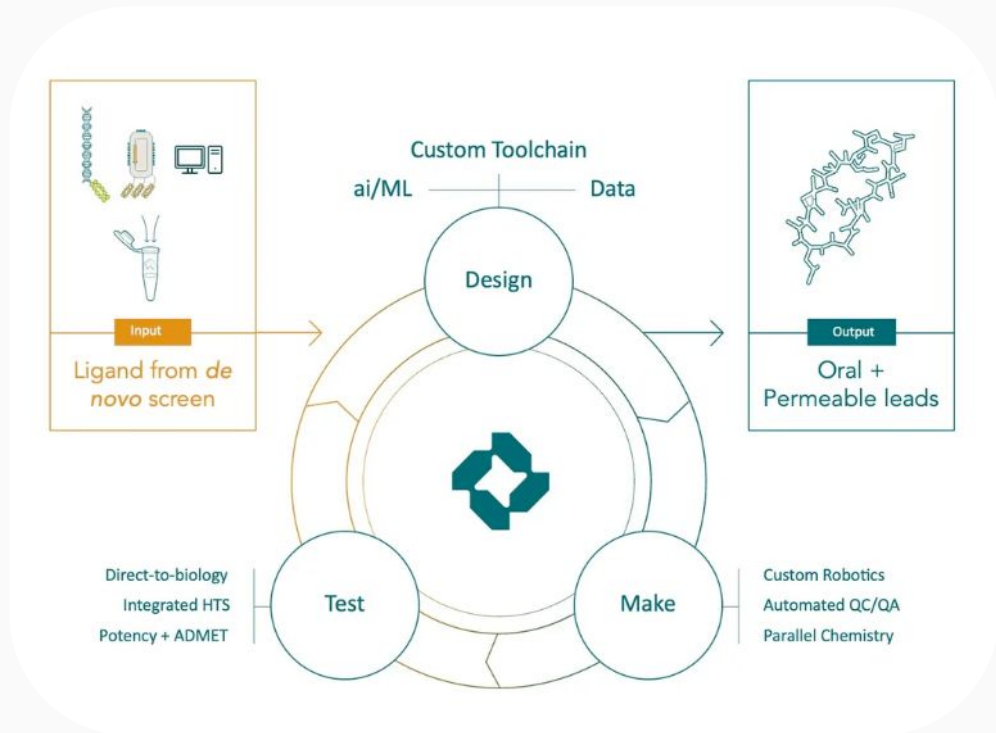
Mark Pruzanski
Scientific Advisor, CEO Alentis
Therapeutics

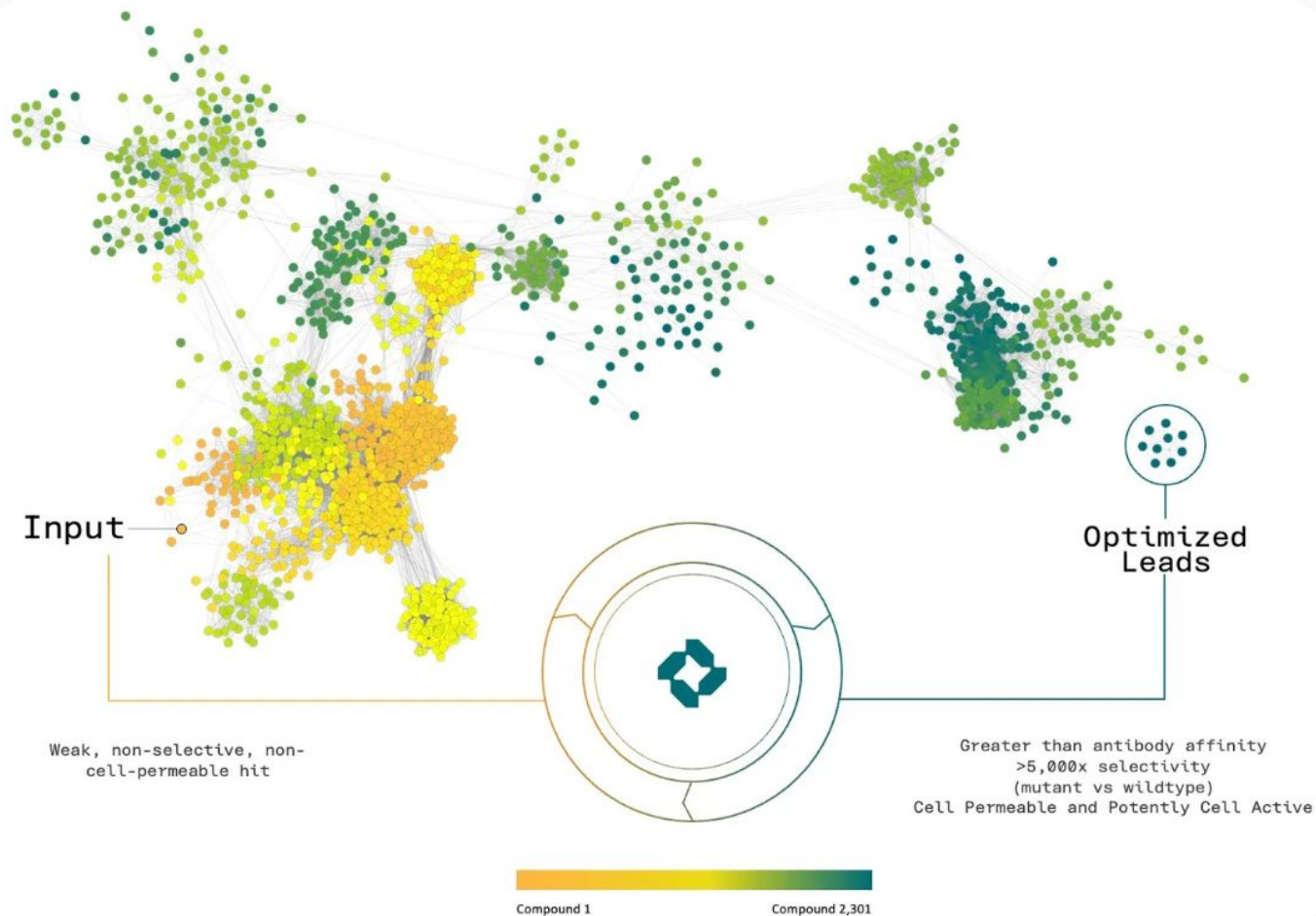


Scott Lokey
Scientific Advisor, UCSC
Professor

What does UNP do?

- Created the “first platform to repeatably engineer synthetic macrocyclic peptides at scale”
- Goal is to aid in designing and making synthetic macrocyclic peptides to make highly potent, selective and drug-like molecules
- “Our portfolio is focused on high value biology inaccessible to traditional small molecule approaches, leveraging our unique platform to deliver medicines for unmet medical needs”
- Basically, they’re looking to help in the design of effective macrocyclic peptides for challenging drug targets

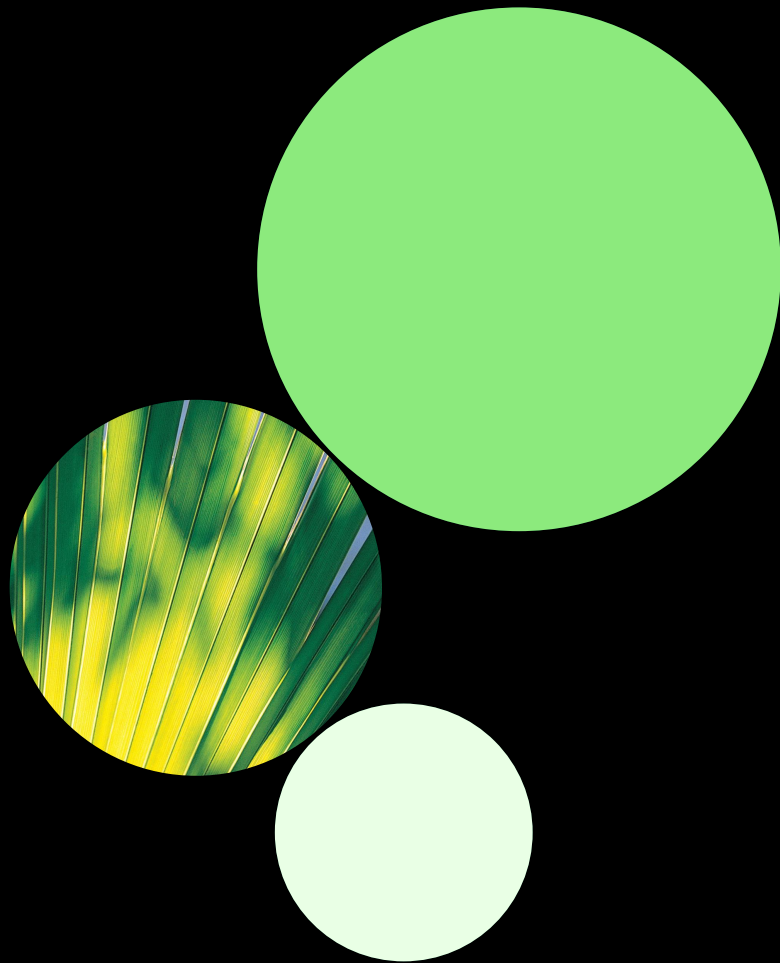






Main partners

- **Novartis**
- **argenx**
- **Merck**
- **bridgebio**
- **Other investors...**





Novartis Press Release

- UNP announced licensing agreement with Novartis to develop macrocyclic peptide therapeutics
 - Particularly for applications in the cardiovascular disease area
- Making necessary tools for leaders in a particular industry... could be the method for big bucks?
- "UNP's integrated discovery engine combines AI-guided molecular design, massively parallel synthesis, and direct-to-biology screening..."
- Agreement terms: UNP will receive up to \$100M in upfront and pre-IND milestone payments and up to \$1.7B in development, regulatory, and commercial milestones, and UNP will get royalties if a drug makes it to market
 - pre-IND: pre-investigational new drug, early interaction between FDA and drug sponsors, discussions about the drug development process
- Pretty recent partnership, press release was February 18, 2026
- "Novartis will assume responsibility for IND-enabling studies and all subsequent clinical development, manufacturing, and global commercialization of products emerging from the collaboration."
- <https://www.globenewswire.com/news-release/2026/02/18/3240126/0/en/Unnatural-Products-Announces-Licensing-Agreement-with-Novartis-to-Develop-Macrocyclic-Peptide-Therapeutics.html>



argenx Press Release

- Again, using UNP's platform to "generate 'potent, selective, and orally available' macrocyclic peptides against a range of undisclosed 'undruggable' targets decided by argenx"
- Deal worth estimated \$1.5B (UNP didn't disclose exact financial details)
 - UNP gets upfront payment and R&D funding
 - Will also get a part of royalties if a drug makes it to the market
- UNP will oversee the R&D up until the studies required before entering a drug candidate into the clinic
 - argenx can then take the therapeutics to human trials and beyond
- July 1, 2025
- <https://www.fiercebiotech.com/biotech/argenx-agrees-15b-pact-turn-unnatural-products-macrocyclic-peptides-new-targets>



Merck & Co. Press Release

- \$220 million deal (ish?) to apply UNP's technology to develop macrocyclic candidates against a 'challenging' undisclosed oncology target
 - Not much information on financial details, but UNP will get upfront payment and development + commercial milestones reaching up to \$220 million
- Merck says that macrocyclic peptides are valuable because "their intermediate size combines the favorable properties of both small molecules and biologics"
 - "The next wave of drug discovery"
- Backer of UNP
- UNP's ambitions as described by this article: "to use its chemistry and AI-driven platform to 'imbue targeted and designed synthetic macrocycles with the favorable drug-likeness of evolved macrocycles found in nature'"
- January 23, 2024
- <https://www.fiercebiotech.com/biotech/merck-co-signs-220m-macrocyclic-peptide-deal-after-hailing-next-wave-drug-discovery>



bridgebio Press Release

- Guess.....
- <https://www.globenewswire.com/news-release/2024/12/03/2990518/0/en/Unnatural-Products-Announces-BridgeBio-Exercises-Option-to-License-Macrocyclic-Therapeutics-for-Development-in-Rare-Diseases-and-Oncology.html>



Thank you! :)

